fighting for supremacy of Islam and against the US, the Pakistan government that supported the US and its allies. Generally, by limiting terrorist attacks, terrorist groups reduce the risk of undermining external political and economic support. The groups that comprise a 'wing' of an insurgency, or are affiliated with above-ground (sometimes legitimate) political organisations, often operate under these constraints. The tensions caused by balancing these considerations are often a prime factor in the development of splinter groups and internal factions within these organisations (Terrorism Research; Goals and Motivations). When SSP adopted a milder approach, the hardliners were disgruntled and they formed LeJ, which became part of TTP.

THE USE OF MEDIA AND THE INTERNET BY MILITANTS

Al Qaeda had been well aware of the power and significance of media for furthering its cause. In July 2005, the Al Qaeda leader Ayman al-Zawahiri wrote to Abu Musab al-Zarqawi, the late leader of Al Qaeda operations in Iraq, 'We are in a battle, and more than half of this battle is taking place in the battlefield of the media.'[2] Osama bin Laden was personally interested in influencing the people of Pakistan through his media messages. On 20 September 2007, he issued a 23-minute-long video tape titled 'Join the jihad: a speech for the Pakistani people from Osama bin Laden, Ramadan 1428, and September 2007'. The picture on the screen showed bin Laden surrounded by four Islamic leaders, among them Abdul al-Rashid Ghazi, the chief cleric of 'Lal Masjid' (Red Mosque), Islamabad, who was killed in a Pakistan Army attack on the Red Mosque. In addition to Arabic and English, the tape was issued in Urdu and Pashtu. Osama castigated the then President of Pakistan General Pervez Musharraf calling for his defeat and the defeat of his supporters through jihad. He described the attack on the Red Mosque as 'a tragic event...with critical implications'. He added, 'Twenty years after the soil of Pakistan soaked up the blood of one of the greatest jihad fighters, the Imam Abdallah Azzam, today Pakistan is witness to the death of another great Muslim, Imam Abdul al-Rashid Ghazi.' Osama called upon Musharraf's soldiers to desert and rid them of his polytheism (Imm, 2007).